

Holidays

Grammar Focus	Topic Focus
Verbs	**Discussing Holidays**
Past Simple	Types of holidays
Past Continuous	
	Sites and resorts
I used to (do)	
I am used to (doing)	Means of transport
Would	
	Holiday equipment
Present Participle	
Past Participle	

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Past Simple

When we use it:

The Past Simple is the English verb tense that expresses the general concept of an action that took place in the past and no longer has any relationship with the present. The duration of the action is irrelevant. The action may have taken place in the near or distant past.

In order to put a verb in the Past Simple, three conditions must occur simultaneously:

1. The action must have **taken place in the past and be finished** the moment you are speaking.
2. The **time** in which the action took place **must be expressed** in the sentence or context.
3. The time expressed must be **passed and finished** while speaking.

Past Simple

Examples:
Christopher Columbus **discovered** America in 1492.
Mozart **wrote** more than 600 pieces of music.
I **didn't do** anything at the weekend.
We **went** to the cinema yesterday.
This morning I **had** pancakes for breakfast.
John **called** me a few minutes ago.
I work in an office, now. Before that, I **worked** in a travel agency.
We **went** to the cinema, last night, but we **didn't enjoy** the film much.

As you can see, all these examples satisfy the three conditions:
1. The action has **taken place in the past and is finished** the moment you are speaking.
2. The **time** in which the action took place **is expressed** in the sentence or context.
3. The time expressed is **passed and finished** while speaking.

Past Simple

The Past Simple is always used to indicate when an event occurred; therefore, this tense is **always associated** with a certain type of temporal expressions.

- **Adverbs of frequency**: often, sometimes, always

Last year I sometimes **played** golf in the afternoons.
I often **went** to the mountains to ski.

- **Expressions that indicate a precise moment in the past**: last week, when I was a child, yesterday, six weeks ago, this morning

We **saw** a good film last week.
She **finished** her work at seven o'clock

- **Expressions that indicate an unspecified moment in the past**: the other day, ages ago, a long time ago

People **lived** in caves a long time ago.
She **played** the piano when she was a child.

Note:
The word ago is a useful term for expressing distance in the past.
It is put after the time period: a week ago, three years ago, a minute ago, many centuries ago.

Past Simple

The Past Simple is very easy to form.

- In **regular verbs**, simply add –ED at the end of the bare infinitive of the verb we need for all the persons to form the affirmative.

- In **irregular verbs**, take the 2nd column of the *Irregular Verb List* for all persons.

Since the Past Simple is a SIMPLE tense, we need an *auxiliary verb*, or "helping" verb, to form the question and negative forms of every verb*. This auxiliary verb is **DO in the PAST,** so **DID**.

Questions are formed by DID + bare infinitive of the verb.

Negatives are formed by DID + NOT = DIDN'T (contracted form) + bare infinitive of the verb.

*This is true for all verbs **with the exception of the verb BE**, which being an auxiliary verb itself, is formed in a different way.

Past Simple

Let's take, for example, the verb **EAT**.
The affirmative is I ATE
The question form is DID you EAT?
The negative form is We DIDN'T EAT

AFFIRMATIVE	INTERROGATIVE	NEGATIVE	CONTRACTED FORM
I ate	Did I eat?	I did not eat	I didn't eat
You ate	Did you eat?	You did not eat	You didn't eat
He, she it, ate	Did he, she, it eat?	He, she, it did not eat	He, she, it didn't eat
We ate	Did we eat?	We did not eat	We didn't eat
You ate	Did you eat?	You did not eat	You didn't eat
They ate	Did they eat?	They did not eat	They didn't eat

Past Simple of BE

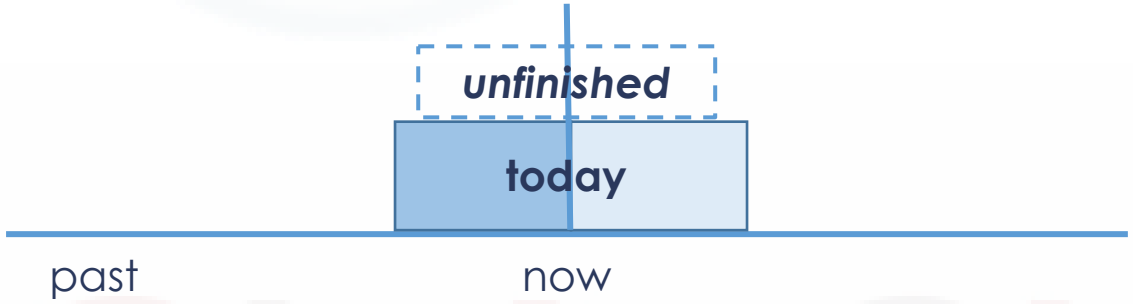
We said earlier that **BE** is an exception, as it is an auxiliary verb itself. We must conjugate the second column of the paradigm (**Past Simple**) to form the affirmative of the verb.
The question form *inverts the subject and the verb*.
The negative form adds NOT to the verb in the affirmative form.

AFFIRMATIVE	INTERROGATIVE	NEGATIVE	CONTRACTED FORM
I was	Was I?	I was not	I wasn't
You were	Were you?	You were not	You weren't
He, she it, was	Was he, she, it?	He, she, it was not	He, she, it wasn't
We were	Were we?	We were not	We weren't
You were	Were you?	You were not	You weren't
They were	Were they?	They were not	They weren't

Compare the Present Perfect Simple and the Past Simple

Present Perfect Simple (I have done)
I'**ve done** a lot of work **today**

We use the Present Perfect Simple for a period of time that continues UNTIL NOW. For example:
today/this week/this year.



It **hasn't snowed *today***.
Have you **seen** Laura ***this morning***? (*it is still morning*)
We **haven't played** tennis ***this week***.
I **have never been** to Russia (*in my life*)

Past Simple (I did)
I **did** a lot of work **yesterday**

We use the Past Simple for a FINISHED TIME IN THE PAST. For example:
yesterday/last week/last year.



It **didn't snow *yesterday***.
Did you see Laura ***this morning***? (*it is now afternoon*)
We **didnt' play** tennis ***last week***.
I **didn't go** to Russia ***last year***.

Past Continuous (or Progressive)

The Past Continuous is used to describe actions or events that started in the past but continue and have consequences in the present. In other words, it expresses an action that is perceived (PERCEPITO) as incomplete or still ongoing in the past.

I was doing something means that *I was in the middle of doing something at a certain time*. The *action* or situation *had already started* before this time, but *had not finished*.

At this time last year I **was living** in England.
What **were** you **doing** yesterday evening?
I waved to George, but he **wasn't looking**.

Past Continuous (or Progressive)

When it is used:

- The Past Continuous is often used to describe the context of a story written in the Past Simple.

'The rain was falling heavily, as the deer (CERVO) came out of the forest. The other animals were hiding in their dens (TANE), to protect themselves from the rain, but the deer moved very slowly. She was looking for her fawn (CERBIATTO), and she didn't notice the hunter who was watching her through his binoculars. She was running to protect her fawn when the shot rang out... '

- The Past Continuous is also used to describe an **unfinished action** that was **interrupted** by **another event** or action, expressed in the Past Simple, and **usually introduced by when**.

I was taking a shower when the doorbell rang.

Past Continuous (or Progressive)

When it is used:

- We often use the Past Continuous and the Past Simple together to say that something happened in the middle of something else:

'I saw you in the park, yesterday. You were sitting on the grass and reading a book.' Here, we do not say 'You were sitting … and you were reading', but just reading, because it is clear to whom we are referring to: to you.

We sometimes use the word *while* in sentences like these, which means *at the same time*
Mark phoned *while* we were having dinner.

- But use the Past Simple to say that **one thing happened after another**:

I was walking along the river when I saw John. So I stopped and we had a chat. He told me about his new job and he asked me how you were.

Past Continuous (or Progressive)

- The Past Continuous is also used to state a change of opinion, expressed in the Present Simple or Present Perfect, as in the following example:

I was going to spend the day at the beach, but I've decided to get my homework done instead.

- The Past Continuous is used with wonder (i.e. ask yourself) + if + could + infinitive to formulate a question in an extremely polite way.

I was wondering if you could babysit for me tonight.

Other examples:
Caroline was skiing when she broke her leg.
When the fire started I was watching television.
Jane called while I was sleeping.
I was wondering if you could help me.

Remember! Some verbs are not usually used in the continuous form (for example KNOW and WANT). You must therefore use the Past Simple.

Past Continuous (or Progressive)

Remember!
I was doing something means that *I was in the middle of doing something at a certain time*. The *action* or situation *had already started* before this time, but *had not finished*.



Yesterday (PAST), Sally and John played tennis. They STARTED at 10 o'clock, and FINISHED at 11:30. So, at 10:30 they WERE PLAYING tennis. They were **IN THE MIDDLE** of playing. They had not finished. They were playing is the Past Continuous.

Past Continuous (or Progressive)

Verbs that are not generally used in the progressive form

*The verbs listed below are generally used in the Past Simple because they refer to a **state** rather than an action or a process:*

Senses / perceptions	Opinion	Mental states	Emotions / desires	Measurements	Other	Exceptions
to feel to hear to see to smell to taste	to assume to believe to consider to doubt to feel (= to think) to find (= to consider) to suppose to think	to forget to imagine to know to mean to notice to recognize to remember to understand	to envy to fear to dislike to hate to hope to like to love to mind to prefer to regret to want to wish	to contain to cost to fit to hold to measure to weigh	to look (= resemble) to seem to be (in most cases) to have (when it means "to possess")	Perception verbs (see, hear, feel, taste, smell) are often used with **could**: I could see ... These verbs can be used in the progressive form but change their meaning

Past Continuous (or Progressive)

Examples:

That coat **felt** nice and warm.	*(**perception** of coat qualities)*
John **was feeling** much better	*(his health was improving)*
She **had** three dogs and a cat.	*(**possession**)*
She **was having** lunch with John.	*(She was having a meal)*
Alice **looked** very tired	*(**perception**)*
She **was looking** at me	*(she saw me)*

Remember! Some verbs are usually not used in the progressive form.
Most of these are STATIVE verbs, because they refer to a state, rather than an action or a process, therefore they are used in the Past Simple tense.

Past Continuous (or Progressive)

The Past Continuous affirmative is formed with the SUBJECT + the PAST SIMPLE of the verb BE + the BARE INFINITIVE of the verb we need + ING.

Example: I was eating He was sleeping We were swimming

Since the Past Continuous is a COMPOUND tense, we DO NOT need an *auxiliary verb*, or "helping" verb, to form the question and negative forms.

Questions are formed by INVERTING THE SUBJECT AND THE VERB BE.

Example: Was I eating? Was he sleeping? Were we swimming?

Negatives are formed by adding NOT = N'T (contracted form) for all persons to the BE-part of the verb.

Example: I wasn't eating He wasn't sleeping We weren't swimming

Compare the Past Continuous and the Past Simple

When Sarah arrived, we were having dinner
We had already started eating before Sarah arrived.

When I met Tom at the airport I was going to Paris
I was at the airport on my way to Paris, when I met Tom

When Sarah arrived, we had dinner
We waited for Sarah to arrive, and then had dinner together

When I met Tom at the airport, we went to Paris
Tom and I met at the airport and then went to Paris together

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I used to (do)

Let's study this example:

Alex doesn't read much, these days.
He has too many things to do.
But he **used to read** a lot.
He **used to read** two or three books a month.

He **used to read** a lot means that *he read a lot in the past, but doesn't do this anymore*.



I used to (do)

'I **used to do'** is something PAST. There is NO PRESENT. You cannot say 'I **use** to do'.
It means something happened in the PAST, but does not happen anymore.

I **used to play** tennis a lot. But I don't play very much now.
Susan **used to spend** a lot of money on shoes. These days she can't afford it (NON SE LO PUÒ PERMETTERE)
'Do you go to the theatre much?' 'Not now, but **I used to**.' (*go to the theatre*)

- We also use **used to…** for things that WERE TRUE, BUT ARE NOT ANYMORE. We use it to talk about something that has CHANGED.

I **used to have** very long hair when I was a child (*but not anymore*)
I've started drinking tea, recently. I never **used to like** it before (*but now I do*)
This building is now a restaurant. It **used to be** a cinema (*but now it's a restaurant*)

I used to (do)

The **affirmative** form is: subject + used to + infinitive
We used to go swimming a lot when we were children

The **question** form is: DID + subject + use to + infinitive?
Did you use to eat many sweets when you were young?

The **negative** form is: subject + DID NOT + use to + infinitive
They didn't use to like going to school when they were kids

I **used to do** is something PAST. There is NO PRESENT. To speak about the present, use the Present Simple. Compare:

Past	He used to play	We used to live	There used to be
Present	He plays	We live	There is

He used to play football, but now he plays rugby
We used to live in the city, but now we live in the country
There used to be a park where now there is a stadium

I am used to (doing)

Let's study this example:

John is British, but has moved to New York. When he first drove a car on the right-hand side, he found it very strange and difficult, because
He **wasn't used to it.**
He **wasn't used to driving** on the right.

But after a few weeks, driving on the right became less strange and difficult, so
He **got used to driving** on the right.

Now John has no problem in driving. It is not strange and difficult for him, because
He **is used to driving** on the right.

Remember! I **am used to** something means that **it is not new, strange or difficult** for me.

I am used to (doing)

Examples:

Jane lives alone. She has been living alone for 10 years, so it is not new or strange for her because she **is used to it**. She **is used to living** alone.

My sister moved to Japan a few years ago. At first it was strange, because she **wasn't used to it**, but after a few months, she **got used to living** there. Now she **is used to living** in Japan.

John **wasn't used to** the rain in England. After some time, he **got used to** it. Now he **is used to** English weather.

After **be/get used**, you CANNOT USE THE INFINITIVE (to drive, to live, to do…). We say:
He **is used to driving** on the right (*not He **is used to drive** on the right*)

When we say '**I am used to** something', **to** is a **PREPOSITION**, NOT a part of the infinitive

I am used to (doing)

You form this structure with:

subject + verb BE + USED + preposition TO + gerund

OR

subject + verb BE + USED + preposition TO + noun or pronoun

Examples:
Jane is used to living alone.
John is used to English weather. He is used to it.

You can also use this structure in the past, when it means a HABIT in the PAST:
Jane **was used to living** alone
John **was used to the rain**, so the English weather didn't bother him.

I am used to (doing)

The ***question*** form is:

Verb be + subject + USED + preposition TO + gerund
Is Jane used to living alone?
OR
Verb be + subject + USED + preposition TO + noun or pronoun
Is John used to English weather? Is he used to it?

The ***negative*** form is:

subject + verb BE + **NOT** + USED + preposition TO + gerund
Jane is not used to living alone. Jane is**n't** used to living alone.
OR
subject + verb BE + **NOT** + USED + preposition TO + noun or pronoun
John is not used to English weather. John is**n't** used to it.

Compare I used (to) and I am used to (doing)

I **used to do** something:
I did it regularly in the **past** but no longer do it.

You can use this structure **only for the past**, NOT for the present.

John **used to drive** on the left, but since he moved to New York, he has to drive on the right.

We **used to live** in the city, but now we live in the country.

SUBJECT + USED TO + INFINITIVE

I **am used to (doing)** something:
It isn't strange or new for me

You can use this structure both for the present and for the past.

John **is used to driving** on the right because he has lived in New York a long time.

We **are used to living** in the country, even if we have to commute every day to the city.

SUBJECT + BE + USED + TO + GERUND/NOUN

Would

- We use **would ('d)** or **would not** (**wouldn't**) (would + infinitive) when we *imagine a situation* (we think of something that is **not real**).

It **would be** nice to buy a bigger house, but we can't afford it.
He**'d love** to live by the sea.

- We use **would have done** (would + Present Perfect) when we *imagine a situation or an action in the past* (we think of something that **did not happen**)

I don't know what I'**d have done** without him! (*but he helped me*)
He didn't tell Jane what happened. She **wouldn't have been** happy.

- Sometimes we use **would** to talk about *things that happened regularly in the past* (similar to **used to**):

When we were children, we **would go** (**used to go**) swimming every day (we did this *regularly*)
Every time they went to the cinema, they **would buy** (**used to buy**) popcorn (they did this *regularly*)

Would

❖ We often use IF in sentences with **would** (2nd and 3rd Conditional sentences)

I **would write** to Mary if I had her email (*but I don't have it – imaginary situation in the present*)
I **would have written** to Mary if I had had her email (*but I didn't have it – imaginary situation in the past*)

She **would go** swimming if she had her bathing suit (*but she doesn't have it – imaginary situation in the present*)
She **would have gone** swimming if she had had her bathing suit (*but she didn't have it – imaginary situation in the past*)

❖ Sometimes **would/wouldn't** is the past of **will/won't**

I'**ll call** (**will call**) Tom later.
I'**d call** (**would call**) Tom, but I don't have his number.

❖ If you say: 'he/she **wouldn't do** something, it means he/she **refused to do** something

I tried to tell him, but he **wouldn't listen** to me.
I asked Alice what had happened, but she **wouldn't tell** me.

Present Participle and Past Participle

When **-ING** forms are used to make **Continuous tense forms**, they are called **Present Participles**.

- The **Present Participle** is often confused with the **Gerund,** which is also casually referred to as the '**ing**' form of the verb. The difference between the Gerund and the Past Participle can be confusing. The main difference is that a **Gerund is used as a noun**:

Taking a vacation is important to your mental health.
We enjoy **watching** romantic comedies.

- **Gerunds** serve the same purpose as **nouns**. They can be the **subject** or **object** of a verb or preposition.

Smoking is bad for your health. (here the Gerund **smoking** acts as the *subject of the verb* BE.)
Singing is his hobby. (here the Gerund **singing** acts as the **object** of the verb BE.)

Remember! Present Participles are often confused with Gerunds.
Although Gerunds and Present Participles look alike, they have totally different grammatical properties.

Present Participle and Past Participle

- **Present Participles** are mainly used to form **Continuous tense forms:**

They **are waiting** for us.
(Here the Present Participle **waiting** goes **after** the verb **be** and forms the **Present Continuous**).

It **has been raining** since this morning.
(Here the Present Participle **raining** helps in the formation of the **Present Perfect Continuous**).

- But the Present Participle can also be used as an active adjective, that describes the *effect* on people or things:

He's an **interesting** person.

She's a **boring** speaker.

Present Participle and Past Participle

Past Participles are forms like wanted, broken, started, begun etc.

Regular verbs have the same past simple and past participle forms.
Examples are:
Want / wanted / wanted Love/ loved/ loved Start / started / started

In the case of **irregular verbs**, the Past Participle is the 3rd column of the paradigm.
Examples are:
Break / broke / broken Begin / began / begun Write / wrote / written

The **Past Participle** forms are used to form **Perfect** tenses and **Passive** verb forms.
They **have left**.
Someone **has broken** the window.
You **are fired**.

Active and passive meanings of participles

- When **-ing** forms (**Present Participles**) are used like **adjectives** or **adverbs**, they have **meanings similar to active verbs**.

Falling leaves = leaves that fall.
A fish**-eating** animal = an animal that eats fish.
Music**-loving** people = people who love music

- When **Past Participles** are used like **adjectives** and **adverbs**, they have **meanings similar to passive verbs**.

Forbidden fruit = fruit that has been forbidden.
A **broken** heart = a heart that has been broken.
A hand-**written** note = a note that has been written by hand.